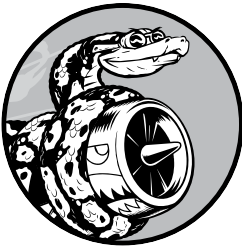


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WORKING WITH APIS



In this chapter, you'll learn how to write a self-contained program that generates a visualization based on data it retrieves. Your program will use an *application programming interface (API)* to automatically request specific information from a website and then use that information to generate a visualization. Because programs written like this will always use current data to generate a visualization, even when that data might be rapidly changing, the visualization will always be up to date.

Using an API

An API is a part of a website designed to interact with programs. Those programs use very specific URLs to request certain information. This kind of request is called an *API call*. The requested data will be returned in an